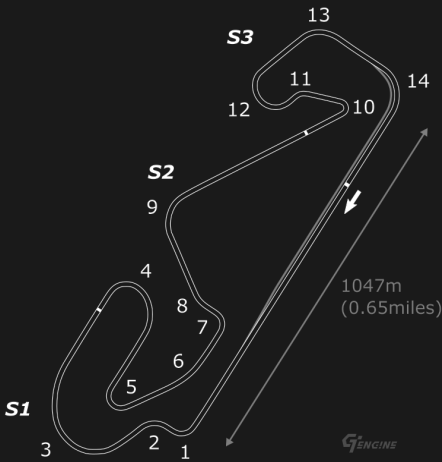


Round 7 — Catalunya GP

Ferrari 458 Italia GT3 | Gran Turismo 7 | BOP: ON

Driver: Charles Fernandez



Circuit de Barcelona-Catalunya GP (No Chicane)

RACE SPECIFICATIONS

Parameter	Value	Parameter	Value
Duration	16 laps	Grid	Standard
Tyre Wear	1x	Start	Standing
Fuel	1x	Tuning	Brake Balance only
Weather	Dry	Qualifying	10 min — Must use RS
Pit Rules	Min 1 pit — Must use RM + RS	Tyre Allowance	RM RS

SITUATION ASSESSMENT

Critical focus areas at Catalunya on this car:

T1 Elf (heavy braking)	MR rotates well under braking — NA V8 gives progressive engine braking.
T3 Renault (blind left)	MR turns in well — NA V8 is more forgiving than turbo/hybrid cars on exit.
T7 Wurth (long right)	Right-rear loads on sustained lateral — MR weakness but NA V8 is smoother.
T9 Campsa (fast right)	Right-rear loads at speed — NA V8 is progressive but right-rear still suffers.
T10 La Caixa (braking)	MR rotation advantage — NA V8 engine braking is smooth and predictable.

Standard grid, standing start = qualifying position matters. Good launch is critical. Survive T1 Lap 1.

QUALIFYING PLAN — 10 min | Mandatory RS

- Out-lap: build tyre temps gently — do NOT push through T3 cold
- Flying lap 1: clean banker. No heroics. Get a time on the board.
- Flying lap 2: PUSH — RS peaks on lap 2 at 1x wear
- Flying lap 3: small improvement possible at 1x — commit if tyres feel good
- Final sector: T9 Campsa flat if confident. T10 La Caixa precise — don't ruin the lap.

You have 1 minute before race start to change compound. Decision: start on RS or switch to RM.

■ COMPOUND STRATEGY — Must Use Both RM and RS

Strategy	Stint 1	Stint 2	Pit Window	Notes
A: RS first	RS — Laps 1-8	RM — Laps 9-16	Lap 8	Fast early, safe finish on RM. RS on the 458 is more forgiving than turbo MRs. Still monitor right-rear at T7/T9.
B: RM first	RM — Laps 1-8	RS — Laps 9-16	Lap 8	Consistent start, fast finish on RS. Undercut potential.

- Both strategies are viable at 1x wear. Key factor: do you want track position early (RS first) or late-race speed (RM first)?

At 1x wear, RS lasts the full 8 laps comfortably. Strategy is about track position, not tyre survival.

■ FUEL PLAN — 1x Multiplier

Condition	Fuel Map	Reason
Normal running, clear air	Map 1	Maximum power — standard race mode at 1x fuel
Defending position / pushing	Map 1	Full power always — 1x fuel has no consumption concern
Fuel concern (unlikely)	Map 2	Slight efficiency gain — only if fuel gauge warns

At 1x fuel over 16 laps, fuel is NOT a concern. Run Map 1 the entire race. Do not overthink fuel — focus on tyres and track position.

■ BRAKE BALANCE PLAN

Phase	Setting	Reason
Opening laps (traffic)	-2 to -3	Front-biased for stable stops in traffic
Mid-race (clear air)	-1 to -2	Slightly less front as rears settle
Final stint (worn tyres)	-1 to -2	Maintain front bias — MR always rotates

■ **NEVER go positive. MR rotates under braking. Positive bias = snap oversteer. NA V8 is more forgiving but still MR.**

■ STANDING START PROTOCOL

- Standard grid — qualifying position is your starting position. Qualify well.
- MR traction is good. Clean launch, protect position into T1. Use rotation at T1.
- T1 Elf on Lap 1 is a contact magnet. Be cautious. Positions are won over 16 laps, not Turn 1.
- If you lose a position at the start, T1 and La Caixa give you opportunities every lap.

■ KEY DRIVING NOTES — CORNER BY CORNER

T1 ELF (HEAVY BRAKING)

- MR rotation helps — NA V8 engine braking is progressive
- Trail brake to turn in. Front-biased balance.
- Good overtaking corner — NA V8 is predictable under braking.

T3 RENAULT (BLIND LEFT)

- MR turns in well blind — NA V8 is smoother on exit than turbo cars
- Still respect the downhill — commit to apex, smooth throttle
- More forgiving than the 296 but still an MR. Progressive power.

T7 WURTH (LONG RIGHT)

- Right-rear loads under sustained lateral — less severe than turbo MR
- NA V8 power delivery is smooth — use that advantage
- Patient arc, smooth throttle. Protect the right-rear.

T9 CAMPSA (FAST RIGHT)

- Right-rear loads at speed — but NA V8 is more progressive
- Smooth entry, committed. NA V8 allows more confidence mid-corner.
- Do NOT lift though — MR oversteer is still present at speed.

T10 LA CAIXA (HEAVY BRAKING)

- MR rotation + NA V8 engine braking = smooth, confident braking
- Downhill approach — predictable and stable with front bias
- Good overtaking corner. Commit to the late brake.

OVERTAKING ZONES:

- T1 Elf — MR rotation advantage, NA V8 progressive braking
- T10 La Caixa — downhill braking, smooth deceleration
- Main straight — NA V8 exit speed from T16

■ WHAT WILL LOSE THE RACE

#	Mistake	Consequence
1	Wrong compound strategy	Must use both RM and RS. Plan the pit window.
2	Positive brake balance	MR + positive = snap. Even the forgiving 458 snaps.
3	Overdriving T7/T9	Right-rear degrades on sustained rights. Patience.
4	Overconfidence	458 is forgiving — but not invincible. Respect MR limits.
5	T1 Lap 1 contact	Survive Turn 1. NA V8 consistency wins the race.

■ SIMPLE EXECUTION SUMMARY

QUALIFY RS -> 2-3 flying laps -> box

PRE-RACE Decide: start RS or switch to RM (1 min window)

LAP 1 STANDING START. Survive T1. No contact.

LAP 2-7 Classic forgiving MR with progressive NA V8. More predictable than turbo/hybrid MR cars.
Right-rear management still key.

LAP 8 PIT. Switch compound (RS->RM or RM->RS).

STINT 2 Push on fresh compound. Exploit tyre advantage.

FINAL LAPS Protect position. Manage tyres to the flag.

WIN ON CONSISTENCY. FUEL MAP 1 ALL RACE.